

QUARTERLY GROWTH REVIEW · FISCAL YEAR 2026

THE HUNTSVILLE EFFECT

A formal statistical review of gang membership growth from Thursday, August 20, 2026, the Thursday before the Huntsville Hamfest, through Thursday, October 1, 2026. That is 43 days. We counted them twice.

Prepared by: Gang Leadership, Office of Numbers and Stuff

Source: The official BKG roster spreadsheet, every row, including the weird ones

Reviewed by: Nobody. Approved anyway.

AUDITED (BY US)

AGENDA ITEM 01 *EXECUTIVE SUMMARY*

Members of the Board, thank you for attending. We went to Huntsville with a folding table, a stack of membership forms, and no plan. We came back with more than double the gang. Our consultants describe this as "unprecedented." We do not have consultants, but we are confident they would say that.

TOTAL MEMBERSHIP

276 → 604

Gang size went up 2.19 times in 43 days.

NET NEW MEMBERS

+328

That is 118.8% growth, issued as BKG #276 through BKG #604.

RECRUITING PACE

7.6/day

Up from 0.72 per day during our first year. That is about 10.6 times faster.

BEST SINGLE DAY EVER

61

Saturday, August 22, on the floor of the Huntsville Hamfest.

U.S. STATES REPRESENTED

36 → 45

Nine new states. Five to go. We are aware of which five.

COUNTRIES REPRESENTED

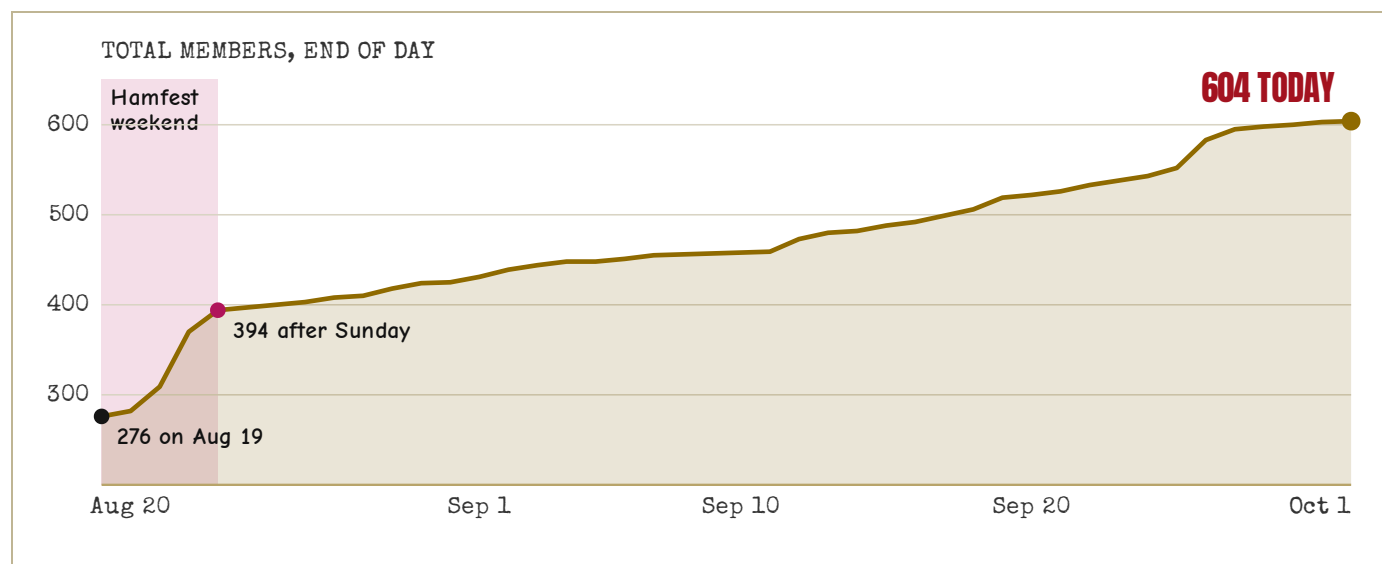
8 → 12

New: Canada, Croatia, Japan, and Poland. The gang is now international, legally speaking.

For comparison: it took us from August 2, 2025 to August 19, 2026, which is 383 days, to recruit the first 276 members. It took 43 days to recruit the next 328. We did not see this coming, and we would like that on the record.

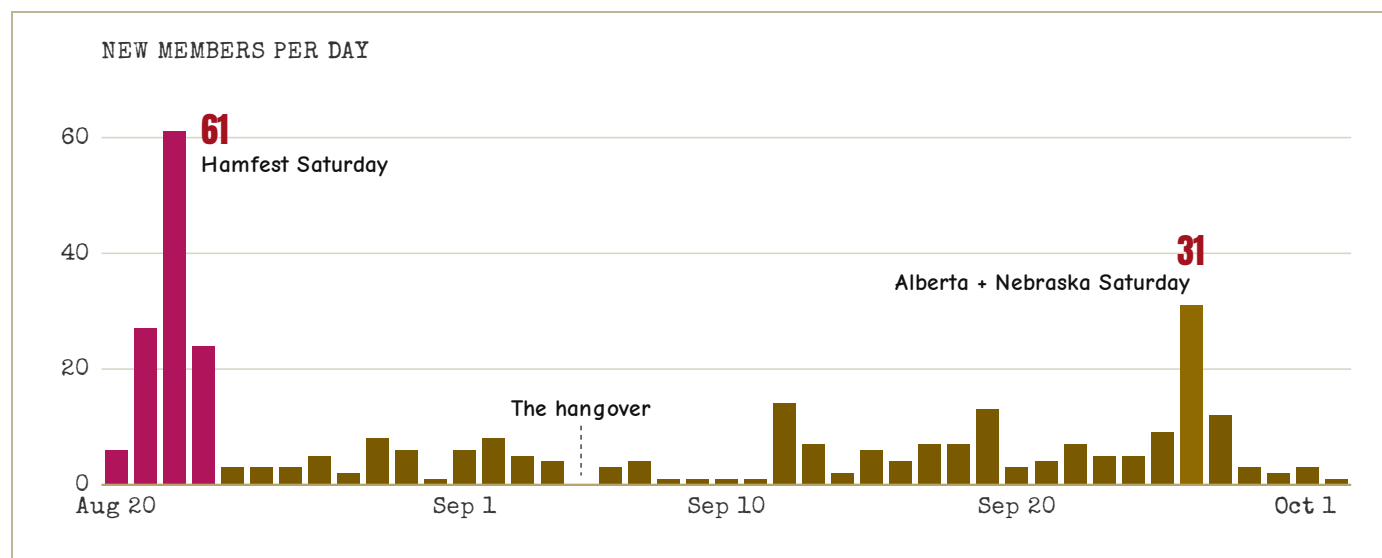
AGENDA ITEM 02 **TOTAL MEMBERSHIP OVER TIME**

Below is our cumulative membership, counted at the end of each day. In corporate language, the line goes "up and to the right." In gang language, the line goes up and to the right.



AGENDA ITEM 03 **DAILY NEW MEMBERS**

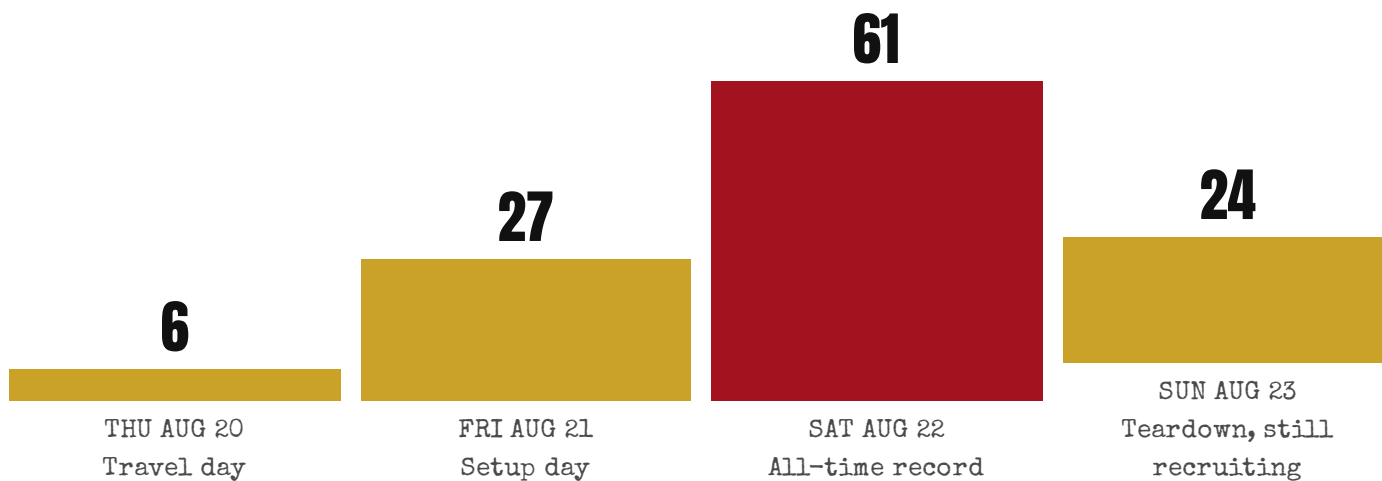
New members by join date. The tall pink bars are Hamfest weekend. The flat part in the middle is what analysts call "the hangover." The second spike is what analysts call "Canada and Nebraska showed up on the same Saturday."



WEEK	DATES (THURSDAY TO WEDNESDAY)	NEW MEMBERS	BOARD COMMENTARY
1	Aug 20 – Aug 26	127	Hamfest. Historic. We had to borrow pens.
2	Aug 27 – Sep 2	36	Still riding the wave. Still finding forms in our pockets.
3	Sep 3 – Sep 9	18	The hangover. Includes September 5, which had zero. See Audit Findings.
4	Sep 10 – Sep 16	35	Recovery. The Kentucky chapter woke up.
5	Sep 17 – Sep 23	46	Growth without a hamfest. Nobody can explain this either.
6	Sep 24 – Sep 30	65	Best week since Huntsville. Alberta, eh. See Agenda Item 07.
—	Oct 1 (so far)	1	Welcome, BKG #604. You are the most recent member and therefore the most important person in this room.

AGENDA ITEM 04 **HAMFEST WEEKEND BREAKDOWN**

From Thursday through Sunday, the gang added 118 members. That is 36% of all growth in this review period, achieved in 4 of the 43 days. The Board would like to formally thank the Huntsville Hamfest and the ARRL National Convention for hosting what was, from our perspective, a recruiting event.



On Saturday alone the gang issued 61 numbers, roughly one every eight minutes of a typical show day. Our previous best single day was May 16, 2026, with 16 members. It was not close.

AGENDA ITEM 05 **TOP EARNERS**

The following members recruited the most new members during the review period. In a normal company, they would get a bonus. Here, they get this table.

RANK	CALLSIGN	MEMBER	RECRUITS	OUTPUT
	N4BKY	Becky S., Alabama	23	
	KI7QCF	Forrest S. (BKG #1), Utah	21	
	N9HO	Justin R., Alabama	21	
4	K5OHY	Tim H., Texas	15	
4	VE6LK	Vince D., Canada	15	
6	N1RWJ	Rob J., Rhode Island	13	
7	K4ZSR	Zach R., Kentucky	11	

MEMBERS WHO RECRUITED SOMEONE

111

Different sponsors brought in at least one new member during the period.

FIRST-TIME RECRUITERS

79

Of those 111, 79 had never sponsored anyone before. The pyramid is a tree now. Please do not call it a pyramid.

FOUNDER OUTPUT

44

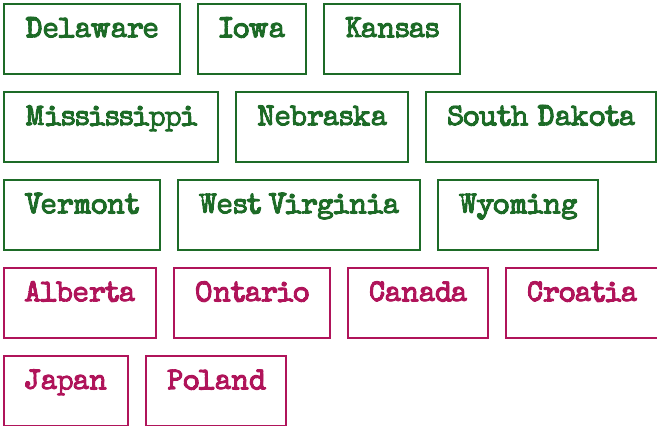
All-time recruits by BKG #1, KI7QCF. Still number one. Still undefeated.

AGENDA ITEM 06

TERRITORY EXPANSION

NEW TERRITORIES ACQUIRED

We entered 15 new states, provinces, and countries during the review period. None of these were planned. We would like to apologize to nobody.



Green: new U.S. states. Pink: new international territory. Alberta alone delivered 13 members. That is more than 30 of our 45 U.S. states have in total.

WHERE THE NEW MEMBERS CAME FROM

REGION	NEW
Georgia	29
Alabama	27
Texas	24
California	23
Tennessee	20
Florida	17
North Carolina	17
Alberta	13
Pennsylvania	12

Special recognition goes to the home team. Alabama went from 9 members to 36, which is four times bigger in six weeks. The Southeast as a whole (Georgia, Alabama, Tennessee, Florida, the Carolinas) produced 118 new members, which is the same as the entire Hamfest weekend, which is a coincidence, which we find spooky.

AGENDA ITEM 07

SPECIAL RECOGNITION: THE CANADIAN OGS

On September 17, the gang had zero members in Canada. Two meters is line of sight, the nearest members were hundreds of miles away on the wrong side of the border, and the rules say you only get in by making a 2-meter CW contact with someone already in the gang. Two Canadians looked at that problem and decided to overcome it in the most difficult ways available. The Board recognizes them both.

CASE STUDY A · ALBERTA

VINCE, VE6LK, BKG #500

Vince did not want an easy induction at a picnic table or on a summit with everyone standing around. His rule was that each station had to be in its own country. So he drove more than three hours south from home to the Alberta–Montana border. Devin "Gato" Felix, N7HNT, drove about four hours north from Helena, Montana, to meet him on the other side.

DRIVING	Roughly seven hours, combined, one way
DISTANCE	About 2.5 kilometers, station to station
POWER	5 watts or less, the whole time
RESULT	First Canadian member, September 18, 2026

Vince's write-up asks whether a contact across the border counts as DX. His ruling was yes, even at 2.5 kilometers. The Board agrees.

Return on investment: In the 11 days after he joined, Vince recruited 15 new members, including 13 in Alberta. Seven hours of driving helped deliver the gang's second-biggest day ever, September 26, with 31 new members.

CASE STUDY B · ONTARIO

JOSH, VE3YTX, BKG #531

Josh is a new ham who caught the CW bug. When he started, there were no members in Canada, and the closest ones were about 200 miles away in the United States. On 2 meters, that is a rough situation. A member suggested he build a tape measure Yagi and try for a 2-meter CW contact through a satellite instead. The homemade antenna did not quite get the job done. So Josh went out, bought a commercial Arrow II Yagi, and tried again.

METHOD	2-meter CW, by satellite, through space
ANTENNA	Tape measure Yagi (partial success), then a store-bought Arrow II (full success)
CONTACT	N9HO, the gang's Alabama and Satellite OG
PIVOT	Bought an Arrow II. Made the contact.

His write-up is titled "A New Ham's Guide to Overcomplicating Everything." The Board would like to state that this is the correct amount of complicated. When the homemade antenna came up short, he did not quit. He went shopping. In business this is called "increasing capital expenditure." It worked.

Return on investment: Ontario OG, joined September 22, 2026. He recruited 3 more Ontario members within 3 days.

Combined impact: Canada went from 0 members to 19 in 12 days. One man drove to a border. One man went to space. Both of these are now considered official BKG recruiting strategies.

AGENDA ITEM 08 **AUDIT FINDINGS**

In the interest of transparency and good corporate governance, our internal audit team (one guy with a spreadsheet) reviewed every row. The following irregularities were found.

FINDING 1 Two members are recorded as joining in the year 26 A.D. One join date reads "8/20/0026." Another reads "0026-09-03."

Resolution: Corrected to 2026. Ham radio was not invented yet, so the auditors accepted the correction.

FINDING 2 88 of the 328 new members, or 27%, had their names entered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS.

Resolution: None required. Excitement is a leading indicator.

FINDING 3 Five new members are listed by first name only, including Don, Steve, Geoff, Ethan, and Brent. Like Cher.

Resolution: Their callsigns are on file. That is all the government needs, and it is all we need.

FINDING 4 On Saturday, September 5, the gang recruited zero members. This is the only day in the review period with no growth.

Resolution: A meeting has been scheduled about the meeting. Then we recruited 14 people the next Saturday.

FINDING 5 Membership numbers were not always issued in date order. BKG #283 is dated August 19, the day before BKG #276.

Resolution: Hamfest paperwork was processed in the order it came out of people's pockets. This is fine.

AGENDA ITEM 09 **FORWARD GUIDANCE**

If the gang keeps recruiting at the review-period pace of 7.6 members per day, the following milestones are projected. These projections are not financial advice. They are barely advice.

MEMBER #1,000

Nov 22

Estimated date, 2026.

Whoever it is, please be ready to pose for a picture.

YEAR-END MEMBERSHIP

~1,300

Projected for December 31, 2026, assuming no hamfests. With a hamfest, all bets are off.

STATES REMAINING

5

Still missing: Alaska, Hawaii, Maine, Minnesota, and Wisconsin. We know who you are. We are coming with a CW key.

Risk factors: band conditions, the solar cycle, running out of membership forms, and the possibility that Huntsville was a one-time event. Management believes the possibility that Huntsville was a one-time event is low, because September did 178 members without one.

CLOSING **MOTION BEFORE THE BOARD**

Whereas the gang had no growth strategy, and whereas the gang more than doubled anyway, be it resolved that:

1. We keep doing whatever this was.
2. We bring more membership forms to the next hamfest. A lot more.
3. Every new member gets on the air and makes a QSO with someone who is not yet in the gang.
4. Nobody asks how the Board meeting went. It went great.

MOTION SECONDED. MOTION CARRIED. 🙌

Data: the BKG roster spreadsheet as of October 1, 2026, 604 rows. The review period runs Thursday, August 20 through Thursday, October 1, 2026, inclusive, and is counted by each member's recorded join date.

Canadian case studies: "Does a Cross-Border Contact Count as DX?" by Vince, VE6LK, and "A New Ham's Guide to Overcomplicating Everything: 2M Satellite CW To Get in a Gang?" by Josh, VE3YTX, both on QRPer.com.

*Not actually confidential. Please share it with everyone you know, especially people who are not in the gang yet.